

Andes Copper Corp — On-Site Audit Report

Facility:	Underground mine and processing complex, Antofagasta region, Chile
Audit type:	ICMM-aligned safety & labor audit, with community relations review
Audit dates:	2026-02-16 to 2026-02-19 (4 days)
Auditor:	Meridian Assurance Partners (third-party)
Overall rating:	Conditional — Medium Risk

Executive Summary

This audit found Andes Copper Corp's underground operations to be generally well managed, with strong community relations and tailings management, but identified ventilation and fatigue-management gaps in underground haulage and drilling operations that require follow-up.

Health & Safety

Facility incident records show two lost-time injuries in underground haulage operations over the preceding 12 months, below the industry benchmark but above the facility's own internal target of zero. Mandatory rest periods under the site's fatigue-management policy were not consistently logged for night-shift drill crews — records were complete for day shift but incomplete for roughly a third of sampled night-shift records. Ventilation monitoring in the Level 7 decline showed diesel particulate matter readings intermittently above the site's internal action threshold, though within regulatory limits.

Tailings & Environmental

The site's tailings storage facility inspection was current and passed with no findings, consistent with the facility's Global Industry Standard on Tailings Management self-assessment.

Community Relations

Interviews with representatives of two neighboring communities found the grievance process to be functioning well, with reported complaints (primarily dust and truck traffic) acknowledged and addressed within the facility's stated response windows.

Training & Competency

Underground haulage and drilling operators sampled (22 of an estimated 140 underground workforce) all held current statutory competency certification. Refresher training on the site's fatigue-management policy was last delivered site-wide in 2025-09, and the auditor recommends this be repeated alongside the ventilation and logging corrective actions below, since the incomplete night-shift logs suggest the policy's rationale may not be fully understood by night-shift crews.

Documentation Review

Equipment maintenance logs for underground ventilation fans were reviewed for the preceding 12 months and found complete and current, with no overdue maintenance intervals — the elevated particulate readings noted above therefore appear to reflect an airflow design or utilization issue in the Level 7 decline rather than an equipment fault.

Corrective Action Log

Finding	Severity	Due Date	Status
Elevated diesel particulate readings, Level 7 decline	Major	60 days	Open
Incomplete fatigue-management logs, night-shift drill crews	Minor	45 days	Open

Conclusion

Recommendation: conditional pass. Follow-up audit scheduled for 2026-04-20 (60 days) to verify ventilation remediation in the Level 7 decline. Tailings management and community relations practices are commended as strong.